

LEVEL 1 • TERM 1 • LESSON 8 • FOR PARENTS

8 Balance and Swap

WHAT WE DID

We learned that the equals sign means 'the same amount as', like a balanced see-saw. Your child balanced two plates of small things and found missing numbers like 6 + 3 = 5 + ___. Give and take: when one number goes up, the other goes down by the same amount. Term 1 goes beyond the school Primary 1 syllabus on purpose, so some sums have tens; we explore them with objects first.

> **Adjust one side, adjust the other. When one number goes up, the other goes down by the same amount.**

TRY AT HOME (5 MINUTES)

1. Two plates: put two piles of small things on each plate. Ask: do the plates match? Give one thing across and count again.
2. Say it: write 8 + 5 = 9 + ___ and ask your child to say how the 8 moved and what that means for the 5.
3. Make a mistake on purpose: write 7 + 3 = 8 + 3 and ask your child to find what is wrong and fix it.

When your child is stuck

Please let your child use two plates and small things or draw the two sides, and wait 10 seconds before helping. Asking 'what could you try?' works better than giving the answer.

Words we used

- equals (=): the two sides are the same amount
- balance: both sides hold the same
- give and take: add some to one number and take the same from the other
- blank: the line where the missing number goes

Good questions

- How do you know?
- Did the first number go up or down?
- What must the other number do?

Things to have ready

- About 30 small things of one kind: buttons, dried pasta, paper clips or coins of one kind
- Two plates, bowls or sheets of paper (one marked LEFT and one marked RIGHT)
- The printed workbook (pages 1 to 5) and the kit page (tens bars and ones squares), already cut out by a grown-up

Next lesson

Lesson 9: Draw and Measure. Your child needs a pencil, paper and a ruler marked in centimetres (the kind in a pencil case). Please have one ready. Missed a lesson? Every lesson is recorded; your tutor will share a private link with enrolled families.